

Admit Card | Venue Rules | Exam Timings | What to Carry

Section-wise Strategy | All Official Regulations | Top Score Tactics

Advertisement No.	CRPD/CR/2026-27/17 — State Bank of India
Post	Junior Associate (Customer Support & Sales) — Clerical Grade
Total Vacancies	9,766 across all states
Your Category	OBC-NCL — Maharashtra
Prelims Dates	26 September, 27 September and 3 October 2026
Mains Date	23 November 2026
Admit Card	Available on sbi.bank.in — approx. 20 September 2026
Selection Process	Prelims (Qualifying) → Mains (Merit) → LPT → Document Verification
Official Website	www.sbi.co.in / sbi.bank.in / recruitment.sbi.co.in

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HOW TO DOWNLOAD YOUR ADMIT CARD

Step 1 Go to official website

Open sbi.bank.in OR recruitment.sbi.co.in on your browser. Do NOT use Google — type the URL directly to avoid phishing sites.

Step 2 Find the notification link

Look for "SBI Junior Associate 2026 — Admit Card" or "CRPD/CR/2026-27/17". It will be prominently displayed on the homepage.

Step 3 Enter login credentials

Registration Number (from your application confirmation email) + Date of Birth (DD/MM/YYYY) + Captcha code.

Step 4 View and verify

Check ALL details carefully before downloading: Name, DOB, Category (OBC-NCL), Exam Date, Session, Centre Address, Photo, Signature.

Step 5 Download the PDF

Click "Download Admit Card." Save the PDF file immediately to your phone and laptop both.

Step 6 Print TWO copies

Print on A4 white paper. Black & white is acceptable. Ensure photo and signature are clearly visible. Do NOT print on glossy paper.

Step 7 Keep digital backup

Send the PDF to your email or WhatsApp so you have a backup if the printed copy gets damaged.

WHAT YOUR ADMIT CARD CONTAINS — VERIFY EVERY FIELD

Field on Admit Card	What to check
Candidate Name	Must exactly match your Aadhaar card. Any mismatch = entry denied.
Roll Number	Your unique exam roll number. Needed in the exam hall.
Registration Number	Your application reference number.
Date of Birth	Verify DD/MM/YYYY format.
Category	Must show OBC (Non-Creamy Layer). Incorrect category = disqualification.
Exam Date	Check whether your date is 26 Sep, 27 Sep, or 3 Oct 2026.
Exam Session / Timing	Morning (~8:00 AM), Afternoon (~11:00 AM), or Evening (~2:00 PM) — check carefully.
Exam Centre Name	Full name and address of your assigned centre.
Exam Centre Code	3-4 digit code. Note this.

Field on Admit Card	What to check
Photograph	Your uploaded photo — must be clearly visible and recognisable.
Signature	Your uploaded signature — must be clearly visible.
Post applied for	Junior Associate (Customer Support & Sales)

If ANY detail on your admit card is **WRONG** (especially name, category, or exam date), immediately contact SBI at crpd@sbi.co.in or the SBI helpline before your exam date. Do NOT attend the exam with incorrect details.

Admit card release date: Expected around 20 September 2026. Check sbi.bank.in daily from 18 Sep. The admit card is **MANDATORY** — entry is strictly denied without it. NO duplicate or re-issue at the exam centre.

Chapter 2 | Exam Schedule

Dates · Sessions ·
Reporting Times

PRELIMS EXAM DATES AND SESSIONS

SBI Clerk 2026 Prelims will be conducted over multiple shifts across 3 dates. SBI assigns your specific date and session — you CANNOT change it. Attend only on your assigned date.

Date	Session	Exam Time	Gate Opens	Arrive By
26 September 2026 (Friday)	Session 1	8:00 AM – 9:00 AM	7:00–7:15 AM	7:45 AM
26 September 2026 (Friday)	Session 2	11:00 AM – 12:00 PM	9:45–10:00 AM	10:30 AM
26 September 2026 (Friday)	Session 3	2:00 PM – 3:00 PM	12:45–1:00 PM	1:30 PM
27 September 2026 (Saturday)	Session 1	8:00 AM – 9:00 AM	7:00–7:15 AM	7:45 AM
27 September 2026 (Saturday)	Session 2	11:00 AM – 12:00 PM	9:45–10:00 AM	10:30 AM
27 September 2026 (Saturday)	Session 3	2:00 PM – 3:00 PM	12:45–1:00 PM	1:30 PM
3 October 2026 (Saturday)	Session 1	8:00 AM – 9:00 AM	7:00–7:15 AM	7:45 AM
3 October 2026 (Saturday)	Session 2	11:00 AM – 12:00 PM	9:45–10:00 AM	10:30 AM
3 October 2026 (Saturday)	Session 3	2:00 PM – 3:00 PM	12:45–1:00 PM	1:30 PM

GATE CLOSING TIME: The exam centre gate closes 15 minutes before exam start. If you arrive after gate closure you will NOT be allowed in — no exceptions, no appeals. Arrive at least 45 minutes before your exam start time.

MAINS EXAM DATE

Exam	Date	Duration	Sections	Total Marks
SBI Clerk Mains 2026	23 November 2026 (Monday)	160 minutes	4 sections	200 marks

Mains admit card will be released separately on sbi.bank.in approximately 2 weeks before 23 November. Prelims result (pass/fail, no marks shown) expected in October 2026.

TIMELINE — FROM TODAY TO FINAL SELECTION

Date	Milestone	Details
19 Sep 2026	TODAY	Practise mock papers. Download admit card from ~20 Sep.
~20 Sep 2026	Admit Card Release	Download from sbi.bank.in. Print 2 copies immediately.
24 Sep 2026	Day before Prelims	Visit exam centre. Pack bag. Sleep by 10 PM.
26/27 Sep or 3 Oct	PRELIMS	60 min 100 Q Qualifying only Target 75+/100
October 2026	Prelims Result	Pass/Fail announced on sbi.bank.in. No marks shown.
23 Nov 2026	MAINS	160 min 190 Q 200 marks Final merit Target 150+
December 2026	Mains Result + Marks	Individual scores displayed for shortlisted.
Jan–Feb 2027	Language Proficiency Test	Marathi LPT if Marathi not in 10th/12th.
Feb–Mar 2027	Document Verification	Originals + photocopies of all certificates.
Mar–Apr 2027	Joining	Training + posting. Mumbai posting if top OBC rank.

Chapter 3 | What to Carry

Complete Checklist
— Prelims & Mains

MANDATORY DOCUMENTS (PRELIMS and MAINS both)

MISSING ANY MANDATORY ITEM = ENTRY DENIED. No exceptions. No alternatives accepted at the exam centre.

MUST HAVE

Printed Admit Card

What exactly: 2 copies (colour or B&W on A4 white paper)

Note: Downloaded from sbi.bank.in. BOTH copies must be clear — photo and signature visible.

MUST HAVE

One ORIGINAL Photo ID

What exactly: Aadhaar Card (preferred) OR PAN Card OR Passport OR Driving Licence OR Voter ID

Note: Must be the SAME ID used during online registration. Photocopy NOT accepted. Expired IDs NOT accepted.

MUST HAVE

Passport-size Photographs

What exactly: 2 photographs (same as uploaded in application)

Note: Recent, white background, face clearly visible. Same specifications as application photo. Write name on back.

ALLOWED ITEMS — What you MAY bring

Item	Condition
Transparent water bottle	Plain, transparent, no label. No juice, no coffee — water only.
Pen	Blue or black ballpoint or gel pen for rough work on provided sheet.
Reading glasses	Permitted if you wear prescription glasses. No smartglasses or camera glasses.
Prescribed medicine	With original doctor's prescription. Inform the invigilator.
Hearing aid	Permitted if medically required. Inform invigilator. No Bluetooth hearing aids.
Wristwatch (simple analogue)	Only a basic analogue watch without any digital display or functions. Most centres now ban ALL watches — leave it at home to be safe.

SAFEST APPROACH: Carry ONLY your admit card (2 copies), original Aadhaar, 2 photographs, a pen, and a transparent water bottle. Nothing else. This eliminates any risk of being stopped at the gate.

WHAT TO WEAR — Dress Code

Dress Item	Rule / Advice
Comfortable clothing	No specific uniform required. Wear comfortable, breathable cotton in September heat (Mumbai).
Avoid full-sleeve shirts	Invigilators check forearms for writing. Full sleeves may be asked to be rolled up.

Dress Item	Rule / Advice
No caps/hats	Remove any cap or hat before entering. Headgear not allowed except for religious reasons (with prior approval).
Footwear	Any regular footwear. Remove shoes briefly at gate for security check.
Avoid heavy jewellery	Metal jewellery triggers security scanners and wastes time at entry.
Hair accessories	Simple clips/bands only. No large metal accessories.

Chapter 4 | Strictly Prohibited Items

Official SBI Rules —
Violation =
Disqualification

ELECTRONIC DEVICES — ALL STRICTLY BANNED

Carrying any of these items into the exam hall — even if switched OFF — is grounds for IMMEDIATE CANCELLATION of your candidature and possible ban from future SBI exams.

Prohibited Electronic Item	Details and reason
X Mobile Phone	Any mobile phone — smartphone or basic. Even switched off. Keep in car/at home.
X Smartwatch / Digital Watch	Any watch with digital display, calculator, Bluetooth, or internet functions.
X Bluetooth Earphones / Earbuds	AirPods, wireless earphones, or any earpiece of any kind.
X Calculator	Standalone calculators or calculator apps. No exceptions.
X Laptop / Tablet / iPad	Any portable computing device.
X Pen Drive / USB Drive	Any portable storage device.
X Bluetooth Device	Any device with Bluetooth capability.
X Camera of any kind	Hidden cameras, pen cameras, glasses cameras.
X Electronic Pen / Digital Pen	Smart pens that record audio or have memory functions.
X Pager / Walkie-Talkie	Any communication device.
X Health band / Fitness tracker	Fitbit, Mi Band, Apple Watch, Garmin — all banned.
X Earphone with wire	Any earphone connected to any device.

OTHER PROHIBITED ITEMS

Prohibited Item	Details
X Textbooks / Notes / Papers	No printed material, handwritten notes, or study material of any kind.
X Blank paper / Extra paper	You will be given a rough work sheet at the centre. Do not bring your own.
X Geometry box / Compass / Scale	No mathematical instruments.
X White-out / Correction fluid	Correction fluid or tape is not allowed.
X Wallet inside exam hall	Leave in locker/bag outside. Carry only ID and admit card inside.
X Bag / Backpack inside hall	Your bag stays in the waiting area or locker (at your own risk). Do NOT bring bag inside.
X Food items	No food inside the exam hall. Eat before you enter.
X Coloured pens	No red, green, or other coloured pens. Only blue or black.

WHAT TO DO WITH YOUR PHONE: Leave it at home if possible. If you must carry it to the centre (e.g. for navigation), lock it in your vehicle or hand it to a family member waiting outside. There is **NO** secure locker facility guaranteed at exam centres for mobile phones. SBI is not responsible for loss of any personal belongings.

COMPLETE ENTRY PROCEDURE — WHAT HAPPENS AT THE GATE

1	Arrive at centre gate Arrive 45 min before your session start time. Gates open 60 min before exam, CLOSE 15 min before.
2	Queue at gate Stand in queue. Have your admit card and original ID ready to show immediately.
3	First check — Security Guard Shows admit card and ID. Guard confirms you are at correct centre and session. Security frisking (metal detector / hand frisk).
4	Bag/belongings check Bags, phones, and prohibited items left at the designated waiting area outside the exam hall. No secure storage guaranteed.
5	Second check — Lab Invigilator At the entrance of the computer lab, invigilator checks admit card and ID again.
6	Biometric registration Fingerprint scan (Left Index finger — same as registration). If fingerprint not matching, alternate finger will be tried. Iris scan at some centres.
7	Photograph capture Live photograph taken by webcam at the computer terminal. This is compared to your admit card photo.
8	Signature on attendance sheet Sign the attendance register with the same signature as on your admit card.
9	Sit at assigned computer Computer terminal number is pre-assigned. DO NOT sit at another terminal.
10	Read instructions on screen Instructions appear on screen before the exam starts. Read carefully — especially the navigation rules.
11	Exam begins The exam starts simultaneously for all candidates at the session start time.

COMPUTER TERMINAL — HOW THE CBT WORKS

Item	How it works
Computer Based Test (CBT)	The exam is entirely online on a computer. No OMR sheet or paper booklet.
Navigation panel	A numbered grid on the right shows Q1 to Q100. Green = answered, Red = not visited, Orange/Purple = marked for review.
Answering a question	Click one of the 5 radio button options (a/b/c/d/e). Your selection highlights.
Changing your answer	Click a different option. Your previous selection is automatically replaced.

Item	How it works
Clearing your answer	Click "Clear Response" to deselect and leave the question unattempted.
Marking for review	Click "Mark for Review" to flag a question to return to. This does NOT answer it.
Section navigation	Prelims has TIME-LOCKED sections. You CANNOT move to the next section early or go back. The system enforces this automatically.
Rough work sheet	An SBI-provided rough work sheet is given. All rough work MUST be done here. Return it to the invigilator at the end.
Clock on screen	A countdown timer shows time remaining in the current section. Watch it carefully.
Final submission	At the end of the last section, the exam auto-submits. Or click "Submit" after the last section.
Exam ends	Log off the terminal. Collect rough work sheet receipt. Sign out register. Leave quietly.

Chapter 6 | Official Exam Rules & Regulations

As per SBI Official
Notification CRPD/C
R/2026-27/17

CANDIDATE CONDUCT RULES — OFFICIAL SBI REGULATIONS

✓ YOU MUST DO	✗ YOU MUST NOT DO
✓ Arrive at the exam centre at least 45 minutes before exam start	✗ Do NOT carry mobile phone, smartwatch, or calculator
✓ Carry PRINTED admit card (2 copies)	✗ Do NOT communicate with other candidates during exam
✓ Carry ONE original valid photo ID	✗ Do NOT attempt to copy or assist in copying
✓ Sit at your ASSIGNED computer terminal only	✗ Do NOT leave the exam hall before the session ends
✓ Raise your hand if you face technical issues	✗ Do NOT take screenshots or photographs of the screen
✓ Return the rough work sheet to the invigilator after exam	✗ Do NOT use unfair means of any kind
✓ Follow all instructions of the invigilator	✗ Do NOT misbehave with exam centre staff or invigilators
✓ Remain seated until the invigilator dismisses the session	✗ Do NOT bring any written material or notes into the hall

UNFAIR MEANS — PENALTIES AND DISQUALIFICATION

Offence	Consequence
■ Malpractice / Copying	Immediate cancellation of candidature + debarment from future SBI exams for up to 5 years.
■ Impersonation	FIR filed. Criminal charges under IPC. Permanent ban from SBI.
■ Use of prohibited device	Immediate cancellation. Device confiscated.
■ Damage to computer/property	Legal action. Cost recovery. Disqualification.
■ Communicating during exam	Warning first, then cancellation if repeated.
■ Attempt to photograph screen	Immediate cancellation and legal action.
■ Leaving hall without permission	Candidature treated as cancelled for that session.
■ Providing false information	Disqualification at any stage, including after joining.

OFFICIAL SBI DECLARATIONS (from Notification)

1. SBI reserves the right to cancel the candidature of any candidate at any point if details provided are found to be false or if the candidate is found ineligible.
2. The merit list will be prepared based on MAINS marks only. Prelims marks will NOT be considered for final selection.
3. SBI reserves the right to modify/cancel the recruitment at any stage without assigning any reason.
4. Category (OBC-NCL) benefit is available only if the certificate is issued by a competent authority and is within validity. The Non-Creamy Layer certificate must be for the current financial year.
5. Candidates who have applied under OBC (Non-Creamy Layer) must ensure their family income is below Rs.8 lakh per annum at the time of Document Verification.
6. Selected candidates will be posted as per SBI's requirements. Preference of posting location will be considered but is not guaranteed.
7. In case of any dispute, the decision of SBI shall be final and binding.
8. The Language Proficiency Test (LPT) in Marathi will be conducted before joining if you have not studied Marathi in Class 10th or 12th.

Chapter 7 | Section-wise Strategy — 60-Minute Prelims

100 Questions | 100
Marks | 3 Locked
Sections

THE MOST IMPORTANT RULE — SECTION LOCKING

SECTIONS ARE TIME-LOCKED. Once 20 minutes are up, you are **AUTOMATICALLY** moved to the next section. You **CANNOT** go back. You **CANNOT** skip ahead. The system enforces this — no manual override possible.

SECTION 1 — REASONING ABILITY: 35 Questions | 35 Marks | 20 Minutes

Time	Activity	Detail
0:00–0:30	Scan all 35 questions	Read just the question type (not full text) for all 35 Q. Mentally tag: Easy (E), Medium (M), Skip (S). This 30-second scan decides the next 19.5 minutes.
0:30–8:00	Puzzle sets — 2 easiest	Pick the 2 simplest puzzle types (linear > circular > floor). Solve in 3-4 min each. 5 questions per set = 10 Q done. Never spend more than 6 min on one puzzle set.
8:00–12:00	Syllogism + Inequality	These are RULE-BASED — fast and accurate. Syllogism: 5 Q in 2 min. Inequality: 5 Q in 2 min. Total 10 Q in 4 min.
12:00–16:00	Coding + Blood + Direction	Coding-Decoding (5 Q, 2 min) + Blood Relations (2-3 Q, 1.5 min) + Direction (2-3 Q, 1.5 min). Total ~10 Q in 4 min.
16:00–19:00	Attempt remaining easy Q	Go back to any skipped questions that are approachable. Do NOT start a 3rd puzzle set now — no time.
19:00–20:00	Final review	Mark any pending answers. Verify any question you are unsure about.

TOPPER SECRET FOR REASONING: In Mumbai, linear seating puzzles (straight row) appear most often in easy/medium difficulty. Always solve linear > circular > floor in that order. If a puzzle feels wrong after 4 minutes, **ABANDON** and move on. An incomplete puzzle set gives 0 marks. Skip it, get more easy marks elsewhere.

SECTION 2 — NUMERICAL ABILITY: 35 Questions | 35 Marks | 20 Minutes

Time	Activity	Detail
0:00–0:20	Scan all 35 Q	Identify: Simplification, Series, DI set type, easy arithmetic.
0:20–7:00	ALL Simplification + Approximation Q	10-12 questions. These are BODMAS calculations — should take 25-30 seconds each. These are your fastest marks. Do ALL of them first.
7:00–10:00	Number Series	5 Q. If pattern clear in 20 sec, solve. If not clear in 30 sec, skip immediately and return.
10:00–14:00	DI Set (Table or Bar Chart)	1 DI set = 5 Q. Table DI is fastest — attempt first. If pie chart, convert % to values first and reuse.
14:00–18:00	Easy Arithmetic Q	SI/CI, Percentage, Average, Profit/Loss. Each in 60-90 seconds.

Time	Activity	Detail
18:00–20:00	Quadratic Equations + Review	Solve quadratics using factorisation shortcut. Deselect any guessed answers if you are unsure.

90-SECOND RULE FOR QUANT: If any arithmetic word problem is taking more than 90 seconds, mark it and move on immediately. You can attempt it at the end of the 20 minutes. Spending 3 minutes on one difficult question while leaving 3 easy questions unread costs you 3 marks.

SECTION 3 — ENGLISH LANGUAGE: 30 Questions | 30 Marks | 20 Minutes

Time	Activity	Detail
0:00–0:15	Read RC questions FIRST	For the Reading Comprehension passage, read all 5 questions BEFORE reading the passage. This tells you what to look for.
0:15–4:00	Fill in the Blanks	5 Q. Context-based. Attempt all. Takes 30-40 sec each.
4:00–9:00	Error Detection	7-8 Q. Apply grammar rules. Check Subject-Verb first, then Tense, then Preposition.
9:00–13:00	Cloze Test	5 Q. Read the full cloze passage once (60 sec), then fill blanks (3 min).
13:00–16:00	Para Jumbles	4-5 Q. Find opener first (no connector, introduces topic). Then conclusion. Link rest.
16:00–20:00	Reading Comprehension	5 Q. Scan passage for answers to the questions you already read. Attempt vocabulary Q first (always answerable without reading full passage).

ENGLISH TOP STRATEGY: Para Jumbles and Error Detection have the highest accuracy rate when done carefully. Skip RC inference questions ("What is the author's main purpose?") — they are subjective and risky. Focus on direct-fact RC questions.

Chapter 8 | Mains Strategy — 160-Minute Plan

190 Questions | 200
Marks | Sections
NOT Locked

KEY DIFFERENCE FROM PRELIMS — NO SECTION LOCKING IN MAINS

In Mains, you can freely move between all 4 sections at any time within the 160 minutes. This is a major tactical advantage — use it to attempt your strongest section first and build confidence and marks early.

160-MINUTE OPTIMAL ATTACK SEQUENCE — YOUR PERSONALISED PLAN

This sequence is customised for your B.E. Computer Engineering background. Computer Aptitude is FREE marks — do it first every time.

Time Block	Section + Questions	Strategy
0:00–8:00 min	Computer Aptitude (10 Q 20 marks)	FIRST. This is free 18-20 marks for B.E. CS. All 10 Q in 8 min. Locks in confidence immediately.
8:00–20:00 min	Easy Reasoning (Syllogism + Inequality ~10 Q)	Rule-based, reliable, fast. No puzzle sets yet. Get 8-10 easy marks.
20:00–45:00 min	Reasoning Puzzles (3 sets x 5 Q = 15 Q)	Solve 3 puzzle sets carefully. 8 min max per set. Skip a 4th set if time tight.
45:00–80:00 min	GK/Financial Awareness (all 50 Q)	No calculation — pure memory. 50 Q in 35 min. Attempt all, skip if genuinely clueless.
80:00–105:00 min	DI Sets (3 sets = 15 Q)	Table DI first, Bar Chart second. Use approximation. Skip caselet if time is short.
105:00–130:00 min	English (all 40 Q)	Fill Blanks → Error → Cloze → Para Jumbles → RC in this order.
130:00–150:00 min	Remaining Quant arithmetic Q	SI/CI, Profit/Loss, Time-Work, Speed-Distance. Easy ones only.
150:00–160:00 min	Review + Remaining Q	Return to marked questions. Attempt only if >70% confident.

SECTION-WISE TARGETS FOR MAINS

Section	Questions/Marks	Your Target	Time	Focus
GK/Financial Awareness	50 Q / 50 marks	38-42	35 min	Study daily from 27 Sep. 15 min per day habit.
General English	40 Q / 40 marks	30-34	35 min	Grammar rules + RC speed reading.
Quantitative Aptitude + DI	50 Q / 50 marks	32-36	45 min	DI strategy + arithmetic shortcuts.
Reasoning + Computer Aptitude	50 Q / 60 marks	48-56	45 min	Computer 20/20 FREE + 3 puzzles + Syllogism.

Section	Questions/Marks	Your Target	Time	Focus
TOTAL TARGET	190 Q / 200 marks	150+	160 min	Top rank in Maharashtra OBC list.

Chapter 9 | Scoring, Cutoffs and Negative Marking

Marks | OBC Cutoffs
| When to attempt vs
skip

MARKING SCHEME — PRELIMS AND MAINS BOTH

Action	Marks	Note
Correct answer	+1 mark per question	Every correct answer gives exactly 1 mark regardless of section.
Wrong answer	-0.25 marks (negative marking)	One-fourth mark deducted for every wrong answer.
Unattempted question	0 marks	No penalty for leaving a question blank. Never guess randomly.
Marked for Review (unanswered)	0 marks	Marking for review without selecting an option = unattempted.
Marked for Review (answered)	Counted as answered	"Mark for Review" after selecting an option = your answer IS recorded.

THE MATHEMATICS OF NEGATIVE MARKING — WHEN TO ATTEMPT

Understanding the probability math prevents costly mistakes:

Confidence Level	Decision	Expected Score (5 options)	Net per Q	Rule
100% confident	Always attempt	+1.00	+1.00	Never leave these blank.
80% confident	Always attempt	$+0.80 - 0.05 = +0.75$	+0.75	Expected gain is positive.
60% confident	Usually attempt	$+0.60 - 0.10 = +0.50$	+0.50	Slight positive — attempt.
50-50 (random guess)	SKIP	$+0.50 - 0.125 = +0.375$	+0.375	Marginal. Skip to save time.
No idea (pure guess)	ALWAYS SKIP	$+0.20 - 0.20 = 0.00$	0.00	Expected score = 0. Skip.

YOUR NEGATIVE MARKING TARGET: Score at least 80 correct with 90%+ accuracy. It is better to attempt 80 Q with 76 correct (score= $76-1=75$) than attempt 100 Q with 78 correct and 22 wrong (score= $78-5.5=72.5$). Accuracy beats speed in SBI Clerk.

OBC-NCL CUTOFFS — MAHARASHTRA (HISTORICAL + YOUR TARGET)

Year	Stage	OBC-NCL Cutoff	Your Target	Your Buffer
2024	Prelims OBC	62 / 100	75 / 100	+13
2024	Mains OBC	74 / 200	150 / 200	+76
2023	Prelims OBC	60 / 100	75 / 100	+15

Year	Stage	OBC-NCL Cutoff	Your Target	Your Buffer
2023	Mains OBC	71 / 200	150 / 200	+79
2022	Prelims OBC	58 / 100	75 / 100	+17
2022	Mains OBC	68 / 200	150 / 200	+82

KEY INSIGHT: The OBC-NCL cutoff in Mains is approximately 70-76/200. If you score 150+, you will be in the TOP 2-3% of all OBC candidates in Maharashtra. This gives you first choice of posting (Mumbai home circle), first choice of branch type, and the fastest promotion track.

Chapter 10 | After the Exam — Results, Mains, Document Verification

What happens after
26 Sep

IMMEDIATELY AFTER PRELIMS (26 Sep onwards)

When	What to do
26 Sep evening	Do NOT discuss answers online or with friends. Different sessions have different papers.
27 Sep onwards	Start Mains preparation IMMEDIATELY. Do not wait for Prelims result.
Daily from 27 Sep	GK: 15 min Oliveboard quiz app every morning. This is non-negotiable.
October 2026	Prelims result expected. Only Pass/Fail shown — no individual marks. If passed, Mains admit card released separately.
Nov 2026	Mains on 23 November. Continue this guide's 58-day plan from Chapter 8 of Topper Guide.
December 2026	Mains result + merit list. Individual scores visible for shortlisted candidates.

LANGUAGE PROFICIENCY TEST (LPT) IN MARATHI

Since you are applying for Maharashtra state and are OBC-NCL (Hindu Kunbi), you will need to demonstrate Marathi language proficiency.

LPT Item	Details
LPT requirement	Candidates posted in Maharashtra must be proficient in Marathi (reading, writing, speaking).
Exemption condition	Exempted if Marathi was a medium of instruction OR a subject studied in Class 10th or 12th.
If studied in Marathi medium (Rameshwar Vidya Mandir, Santacruz)	You may be exempt — verify from your SSC marksheet. Bring certificate.
LPT test format	Reading a Marathi passage + writing a short paragraph in Marathi. Pass/fail only.
When conducted	Scheduled after Mains result, before Document Verification.
If you fail LPT	Not considered for Maharashtra posting. May be offered another state.

DOCUMENT VERIFICATION — COMPLETE LIST FOR OBC-NCL CANDIDATE

Bring ORIGINALS + 2 sets of self-attested photocopies of every document. Arrange in this order:

#	Document	Details	Priority
1	OBC-NCL Certificate (Non-Creamy Layer)	Issued by competent authority (Tehsildar/SDO). Must cover CURRENT financial year 2026-27. Income below Rs.8 lakh p.a. for family.	CRITICAL — check validity date
2	Caste Certificate (Hindu Kunbi OBC)	Original caste certificate showing Hindu Kunbi community under OBC category.	CRITICAL

#	Document	Details	Priority
3	Caste Validity Certificate	Issued by Maharashtra Caste Validity Committee. If not available, request urgent reissue.	CRITICAL
4	B.E. Degree / Provisional Certificate	Rizvi College, Mumbai University, 2020. Degree OR Provisional Certificate accepted.	CRITICAL
5	All B.E. Semester Marksheets	All 8 semesters (2016-2020). If consolidated marksheet available, bring both.	MUST HAVE
6	Class 12 Marksheet + Certificate	HSC Board marksheet showing 76.96%. Passing certificate.	MUST HAVE
7	Class 10 Marksheet + Certificate	SSC Board marksheet showing 93%. Passing certificate.	MUST HAVE
8	Aadhaar Card	Original Aadhaar. Link to your mobile number before DV date.	MUST HAVE
9	PAN Card	Original PAN card.	MUST HAVE
10	Domicile Certificate (Maharashtra)	Proof of 15+ years residence in Maharashtra. Required for state reservation.	MUST HAVE
11	Experience Certificate from eScan	Signed letter on company letterhead from HR — mentioning designation, period (Aug 2021 - Jan 2024 and Feb 2026 onwards).	Bring it
12	Birth Certificate	Birth certificate or Class 10 marksheet as DOB proof.	Any one
13	Passport-size Photographs	8-10 recent photographs, white background, same specifications as application photo.	MUST HAVE
14	Medical Fitness Certificate	From a Government / Civil Hospital Surgeon. Confirms no contagious disease.	Required
15	Discharge Certificate (if applicable)	If previously working in Government service.	If applicable

OBC-NCL NOTE: Your Non-Creamy Layer certificate MUST be for financial year 2026-27 (issued after 1 April 2026). Certificates issued before April 2026 will NOT be accepted at Document Verification. Get it renewed NOW if your current one is from before April 2026.

ARRIVE: 45 min before your session start time

GATE CLOSES: 15 min before exam start — late entry NOT allowed

PRELIMS ORDER: Reasoning FIRST (strongest) | Quant | English

90-SEC RULE: Any Q over 90 sec → Mark and Move On

NEGATIVE MARKING: -0.25 per wrong. Attempt only if >70% confident.

PRELIMS TARGET: 75+ / 100 | OBC-NCL cutoff: ~60-65

MAINS TARGET: 150+ / 200 | Computer Aptitude = 20/20 FREE for B.E. CS

PRELIMS: 26 SEPTEMBER 2026 | MAINS: 23 NOVEMBER 2026